Teacher Guide & Answers

Passage Reading Level: Lexile 1110

1. **B** *They risk dying out.*

2. **A** *how natural selection changed the population of peppered moths*

3. **C** *Predators could see the light gray peppered moths on the black trees covered by soot and easily hunt them down.*

4. **D** *Darker coloring is currently better for the peppered moth's survival.*

5. **C** *natural selection*

6. **B** *open to attack*

7. **D** *As a result*

8. **Suggested answer:** *Natural selection is the process by which species die or live through changes in their environment.*

9. **Suggested answer:** *The environment changed as the trees became black and covered in soot. This was caused by the appearance of factories that emitted smoke.*

10. **Suggested answer:** *As the light gray peppered moths were eaten by predators, the darker moths survived. These dark-colored peppered moths bred with other dark-colored peppered moths and produced dark offspring that were more likely to survive than light gray peppered moths. Over time the peppered moth population became dark-colored as the light gray peppered moths were dying out.*

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